Protocol landscape

MVFP LLM Bots & Agentic Web Workshop

20th November 2025

DKB Strategies

Standards to address two issues

1. Rights reservation

Providing a means by which rights holders can signal if (and how) their content may be accessed (and used) by a non-human web visitor.

2. Licensing

Protocols to facilitate automated transactions for the commercial usage of intellectual property.

Emerging marketplace / protocol landscape

Purpose	**Rights reservation**					
Type	**Protocols / standards**					
	llms.txt	**AI.txt**	**Trust.txt**	**CloudFlare content signals**	**IETF AI Preferences working group**	**W3C Text & Data Mining Reservation Protocol**
Owner	Community proposal	Private - VC-backed	Non-profit	Private - listed (infrastructure)	Standards org	Standards org (community working group)
Model	Proposed standard	Proposed standard	Open spec, IETF draft	Deployed standard	Official standard - undeveloped	Proposed standard
Status	Experimental / limited adoption	Live - limited adoption	Niche adoption	Live	Spec draft - in development	Final specification, awaiting standardisation
Commercial model	N/A	N/A	N/A	Link to proprietary marketplace	N/A	N/A
Scope	Inference	Training	Site-wide data training Y/N	Training, search, RAG,	TBC pending vocabulary	TDM - Y/N, links to TDM policy

Example - Cloudflare content signals

User agent targeting

```
User-Agent: googlebot
Content-Signal: ai-train=no,
search=yes, ai-input=no
Allow: /

User-Agent: bingbot
Content-Signal: ai-train=no,
search=yes, ai-input=no
Allow: /

User-Agent: OAI-Searchbot
Content-Signal: ai-train=no,
search=yes, ai-input=no
    Allow: /
```

Page targeting

```
User-Agent: *
Content-Signal: /about ai-train=yes,
search=yes, ai-input=yes
Allow: /about

# Search-only access to your blog
User-Agent: *
Content-Signal: /blog/ ai-train=no,
search=yes, ai-input=no
Allow: /blog/

# Disallow access to your dashboard
User-Agent: *
Disallow: /dashboard/
```

Examples - W3C TDMrep - JSON file

Simple reservation

```
[
  {
  "location": "/",
  "tdm-reservation": 1
  }
]
```

Directing to policy, unreserved for JPG

```
[
  {
  "location": "/directory-a/",
  "tdm-reservation": 1
  },
  {
  "location": "/directory-b/html/",
  "tdm-reservation": 1,
  "tdm-policy":"https://provider.com/policies/policy.json"
  },
  {
  "location": "/directory-b/images/*.jpg",
  "tdm-reservation": 0
  }
]
```

Examples - W3C TDMrep - HTTP header

Simple reservation

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Date: Wed, 14 Jul 2021
12:07:48 GMT
Content-type: image/jpg
tdm-reservation: 1
```

Directing to a policy

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Date: Wed, 14 Jul 2021 12:07:48 GMT
Content-type: text/html
tdm-reservation: 1
tdm-policy: https://provider.com/policies/policy.json
```

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Technical						
How easy is it to update or revoke policies?	✔	✔	✔	✔	?	✔
Can policies be set at path and asset level?	✗	✔	✗	✔	?	✔
Does it offer use-case granularity?	✗	✔	✗	✔	?	✗
Status / governance						
Is there appropriate governance?	✗	✗	✗	✗	✔	✔
Is it recognised as a rights reservation mechanism under IP regimes?	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	?
Is this subject to widespread sell-side adoption?	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Are they being respected by demand-side platforms?	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗

Emerging marketplace / protocol landscape

Purpose	**Licensing**				
Type	**Protocols / standards**		**Marketplaces**		
	IAB AI Content Monetization Protocols	**RSL (really simple licensing)**	**TollBit**	**CloudFlare pay-per-crawl marketplace**	**Microsoft content marketplace**
Owner	Trade association	Non-profit rights organisation	Private - VC-backed	Private - listed (infrastructure)	Private - listed (buy-side)
Model	Open standard	Open standard	Proprietary	Proprietary	Proprietary
Status	Spec draft - in development	Live - in rollout	Live	Live - pilot	In development - announced
Commercial model	Multiple, including pay-per-crawl, flat fee	Pay-per-crawl	Pay-per-crawl, pay-per-use	Pay-per-crawl	TBC
Scope	Inference, retrieval, training	Inference, retrieval, training	Inference, retrieval, training	Retrieval	TBC

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Technical					
Does the protocol facilitate a flow of data back from licensee to licensor?	✔ *(supports)*	✗	✔ *(supports)*	✗	?
Licensing rules to offer preferential terms across key commercial terms (exclusivity, instant / latent, citations / branding etc.)?	✔ *(some)*	✗	✔ *(some)*	✗	?
Status / governance					
Does a proprietary marketplace connect with liquid demand?	✗	✗	✗	?	?
Is the market controlled by actors with publish-aligned interests?	-	-	✗	✗	✗

Will the market develop in a standardised manner?

Thank you.

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